

APPENDIX 3: BIBCO IMPLEMENTATION

This appendix is intended to assist in planning BIBCO implementation at individual institutions. The policies at each institution will differ depending on the local situation, and the decision-making process may also vary. Provided here are simply some issues for consideration and possible approaches to discussing and deciding BIBCO workflow.

What to treat as PCC

One basic decision is whether to handle all cataloging at PCC level or only certain categories. If only certain cataloging is done as PCC, the following criteria should be considered:

- **Formats:** Should BIBCO records be created for material in all formats? Or only certain formats?

For example, an institution may decide to treat only books and Record Type “a” electronic resources as PCC, while cataloging cartographic, graphic, moving-image, and music materials as non-PCC records.

Call number practice can be a factor. An institution may choose to catalog as PCC only those formats classified using a standard classification system, not formats just assigned accession numbers.

Please note another factor for OCLC libraries: Each library must have OCLC Enhance status for a given format to contribute PCC cataloging for it.

- **Collections:** For example, the policy decided may be:
 - To do PCC cataloging for materials in all collections
 - Not to do PCC records for special collections materials
Or to identify more specific exceptions: e.g., not to handle local theses as PCC
 - To do as PCC only those special collection materials classified using a standard classification system
 - To handle certain groups of materials using collection-level records.
- **Workflow-related:** Among factors to consider:
 - Should PCC records be contributed only for materials being cataloged for the collection for the first time? Or should they also be done in recataloging and other database maintenance work?

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- OCLC institutions: Should PCC records be contributed only as original cataloging, or should copy also be upgraded to PCC?

If any copy is upgraded: Criteria should be considered for determining when just to edit copy locally and when to upgrade it in OCLC. In addition to the level and quality of copy in OCLC – e.g., upgrading all vendor-supplied records, or upgrading all records lacking classification numbers in a given system – the level and training of available staff may well be factors.

- **Languages:** It may be useful to draw up a list of languages in which your catalogers have enough expertise to contribute PCC records.

To contribute dependably useful records, catalogers should have sufficient facility in a language to be able to identify descriptive elements appropriately and perform adequate subject analysis when applicable. For languages in which they have less facility, they should not attempt PCC cataloging.

Certain nonroman-script languages are represented by NACO funnel projects, such as the Arabic Funnel and the NACO Hebraica funnel. They are available for additional review and support. (A list of funnel projects with contact information may be accessed from the NACO Web page.)

- **Dates:** An institution may decide to catalog only current materials, published from a certain date forwards, as PCC.
- **Case-by-case basis:** Within any particular category or for cataloging in general, an institution may decide to leave the decision about cataloging as PCC up to individual cataloger judgment.

PCC level: full or core

Once the decision has been made about what to handle as PCC cataloging, the level of PCC cataloging should be determined, i.e., what to treat as full or as core. An institution may decide to contribute BIBCO records only at full level, only at core level, or at both levels.

When cataloging is done at both levels, possible factors include:

- **Collections and collecting strengths.** For example, policies may be set to catalog materials in:
 - Well-known research collections at full level
 - Primary collecting areas at full level
 - Areas with less curricular emphasis at core level
 - Disciplines with only undergraduate programs at core level
 - Special collections materials at full level
- **Languages:** Based on collecting strengths, available cataloger expertise, and/or other factors, an institution may decide to handle cataloging for materials in certain languages at full level while handling materials in other languages at core level.

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- **Authority records:** The presence or absence of an authority record in the LC/NACO or LC/SACO authority file may be a factor. For example:
 - If providing a 710 heading for a corporate body with a secondary relationship to the work would require considerable extra time to do research and contribute one or more NACO records, there may be a policy of creating a core rather than a full record.
 - There may be a policy of providing core records with untraced series when series have not yet been established.
- **Case-by-case basis:** Within any particular category or for cataloging in general, an institution may decide to leave the decision about PCC cataloging level up to individual cataloger judgment.

Core cataloging decisions

If the decision has been made to do any core cataloging, an institution may wish to set policies about elements to include in or omit from core records, depending on local priorities. Some fields to consider:

- Types of optional **notes** to add, leave out, or add only under certain circumstances. Possible examples:
 - 546 (formats for which it is optional)
 - 504
 - 505 (single-part)
- Types of optional **added entries** to add, leave out, or add only under certain circumstances. Possible examples:
 - Conference sponsors
 - Hosts of exhibitions
 - Local faculty or other locally well-known individuals
 - Analytical uniform titles
 - Uniform titles for certain types of related works
- **Series:** It may be found useful to make decisions on handling not-yet-established series in core records. Should they be tagged in the bib record as untraced series? Or should all series be established as traced series, with authority records provided?
- **Subject headings.** Possible policies:
 - Only primary subject heading access
 - Both primary and secondary headings (i.e., providing subject access at the equivalent of full level)
 - Level of subject access varying depending on discipline

Subject headings may be routinely omitted or provided for individual literary works.

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If core PCC cataloging will be done for non-book formats, format-specific fields and issues should also be considered. As a few examples:

- Should music analytical uniform titles be included?
- Should 508 fields be provided for moving image materials?
- For manuscript collections, should links to online guides be provided?

Copy cataloging decisions

Another set of implementation decisions is likely to be local policies for handling PCC records provided by other libraries -- both full and core. Ideally, such policies should be based on the goal of the Program to reduce the time that other libraries need to spend in handling PCC copy cataloging.

Issues to consider for PCC copy cataloging may vary widely from institution to institution. These policies may be derived from or folded into existing copy-cataloging policies and procedures; alternatively, they may require specific examination and documentation.

Examples of issues to discuss include:

- Elements to accept in core records as they are, without further editing
- Fields to add routinely when they have been left out
- Fields not to spend time in adding
- Series treatment, including whether to trace and establish series left untraced in core records.

Involving others in planning

Serious consideration should be given to involving others in the institution, beyond PCC catalogers, in discussion and planning:

- Copy catalogers / support-staff catalogers (if they do not attend the BIBCO training session)
- Reference staff
- Bibliographers
- Administration
- Special collections staff

By involving people from different areas of the institution and those playing different rôles in it, the following valuable considerations should all be factors in decisions about BIBCO workflow:

- Experienced catalogers' judgment
- Understanding of cataloging, bibliographic services, and technical services priorities and constraints
- Knowledge of current and anticipated institutional priorities and constraints
- Working familiarity with local user needs and interests; in some cases, awareness of outside researcher interests
- Working familiarity with collection strengths

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Involvement also helps to ensure broad institutional support for PCC participation.

It is likely that cataloging managers and catalogers will first discuss implementation issues among themselves. They should be prepared to explain PCC principles and concepts to non-catalogers before discussing specific implementation issues.

Documenting decisions

Written policy documents will facilitate consistency among catalogers and over time in following the decisions made. It should be made clear whether priorities represent across-the-board policies or simply general considerations to assist individual catalogers in making their own choices.

Evaluation

A periodic revisiting of BIBCO-related workflow should be considered. Institutions may find it valuable to follow up on their PCC participation, evaluating their policy decisions in the light of their experiences, in addition to taking into consideration any changes in local circumstances.

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